

EXPLORE.....

**The newsletter of the
Friends of Telford Town Park
FREE - but donations welcome!**



Winter / Spring 2016
Promoting . Conserving . Protecting
www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

Get active with FOTTP



There is currently a vacancy on our committee for a **Secretary**. Please apply via our web site or to the Chair on [REDACTED]

Council Budget proposals 2016 - 2018

We have noted in the Telford & Wrekin Council 2016- 2018 budget proposals that they wish to close the Visitor Centre from November to February each year except for the toilets. Apart from other cuts which will affect the park, the Friends have informed the council that we have voted unanimously against this proposal. We have an award winning park which is enjoyed by the residents of Telford and beyond all year round and it should remain that way. Please make your voice heard if you feel that the Visitor Centre should remain totally open through the winter. We need to ensure that we still actively encourage people to visit our wonderful park ALL year round not just for 9 months of the year.

If you wish to volunteer to help us in the park, particularly if you would like to take on the secretarial role, please get in touch via our web site or direct to the park and leave your details on 01952 382340.

We are very grateful to **Great Dawley Town Council** for assisting the Friends with the partial cost of producing this newsletter and also to **Hollinswood & Randlay Parish Council, Stirchley and Brookside Parish Council, Madeley Town Council, Lawley & Overdale Parish Council, Donnington & Muxton Parish Council and the Southwater Event Group** for their ongoing support of the Friends of Telford Town Park. Thank you all very much..

Cover picture: The Fields in Trust Award for Best UK Park 2015

UK's Best Park 2015



Left to right: BBC Sports presenter Ore Oduba, Chairman of FOTTP Chris Pettman, Park Manager Nicola Allen and Chairman of Fields in Trust Tim Phillips, CBE.

The Friends are very pleased to announce that Telford Town Park was voted the best in the UK 2015 by the general public, voting on the Fields in Trust web site. We were shortlisted as one of 3 to be picked to attend the awards ceremony at Lords Cricket Ground in London. As Nicola and Chris listened to all the other awards presented on the evening, the last award for Best UK Park, the first time Fields in Trust have made such an award, was taken out of the envelope and the winner is.....Telford Town Park !!!! A great moment!

This really is a fantastic achievement, coming as it does on the back of winning the Green Flag award as well, by all who care for and tend our town park and very good news, not only for the park but for Telford as a whole. It will mean more visitors to help keep our town vibrant and a great place to be living in. To anyone reading this who voted for us, we thank you most sincerely, your vote most certainly **did** count.

We now have lots of exciting developments to come in 2016, so we look forward to seeing you in the park again soon.

Chris Pettman, Chairman.

9th Santa Fun Run 2015



Generously supported by



www.cycleexperience.com

0845 434 8451

Last December saw a record number of Santas running through Telford Town Park and Southwater Square in aid of our 2 charities the RNIB and Guide Dogs UK. We are very pleased to tell you that we raised, before costs, around £4,000. A magnificent total and even after costs we should be able to give each charity well over £1,500 each. The day started off damp but we were lucky and had a dry morning and over 250 entrants thoroughly enjoyed their spree for fun and loved the mince pies and mulled fruit punch afterwards as has become traditional. The event was started by the Mayor of Telford & Wrekin, Councillor Leon Murray who also handed out medals at the finish. There followed the draw for the raffle which was generously supported by Nandos, Zizzi, Coal Grill, Chimichanga, Costa Coffee, Starbucks, Cineworld, The Ice Rink and Telford Town Park Adventure Golf. We look forward to this years tenth anniversary event on Sunday 4 December (tbc). We hope to make it really special, so watch out for details on our web site and elsewhere around August time.



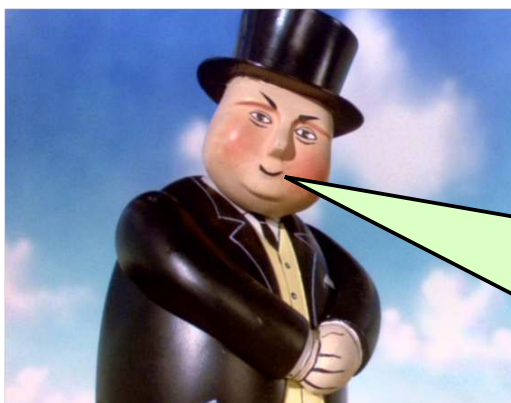
into the park

Saturday 2nd April 2016

11am - 4pm Telford Town Park

This event will be a seasonal celebration of the great outdoors and of course the park being given the Green Flag award and voted Best in the UK.

This year a new tradition will be started by hosting a gardening festival with question and answer sessions plus lots of nurseries and garden centres there to help as well. Young people will not be forgotten either with planting and craft activities, opportunities for bird box making, bug hunting, walking and exploring. A petting farm to hold bunnies and chicks, feed lambs and donkeys and take a horse and cart ride to Stirchley Chimney. Down in the park you'll find an Easter egg hunt along with Thomas the Tank Engine and The Fat Controller! Definitely a date for your diary, do NOT miss it, the gorillas won't !



**SEE
YOU
THERE !**



Chelsea Gardens



Left: The new stumpery prior to planting up

Right: Work in progress by the Friends planting ferns, bulbs and other plants



The gardening has taken a back seat over the Christmas and New Year break but now we are back with lots of exciting things to do. As you can see from the above photos, the stumpery has been started and will be completed early this year. We are also hoping to build, with the help of a small grant, **a bug hotel** at the end of the path. The aim of this wooden construction will be to give small bugs a nice cosy place in which to over winter and also multiply to hopefully enhance the pollination of all the plants.

If you have never visited the gardens, please do come and have a look particularly as Spring approaches as all the cherry blossom will be out then. We have also started repainting the 3 gazebos in the Maxell Garden and will be replanting with heathers, the area near the domed seating in the Chelsea Gardens.

Water has been the main issue in the gardens and unfortunately requires a major 5 figure investment to restore and repair all the electrical circuits and also the 2 fountains and the waterfall in the Maxell gardens. We have also had issues with the mains supply to the gardens and hopefully this will be resolved before too long.

Currently we are looking at various ways of funding this repair work and any ideas will be welcome!

With further council cuts to come which will affect the Town Park, we will be expecting to increase our workload in the gardens and to this end will be seeking more volunteers to help keep these gardens as attractive as when first designed and built in the late 70's and early 80's. We are also looking into the feasibility of selling miniature remembrance tags, to perhaps hang on the metal tree sculpture in the Friends Sensory Garden. This would increase its ability to 'sing' in the wind and would be a constant reminder for loved ones. Let us know what you think and what you would be prepared to pay for one.

That's it for now but hopefully we can continue to improve and maintain the gardens in the way in which they were originally designed.

The Friends operate regular gardening sessions in the Chelsea Gardens. If you would like to help out, just come along one Wednesday between 10am and 1pm and have a chat. No gardening experience is necessary and we have jobs to suit all tastes and abilities. The satisfaction of seeing your handiwork grow and bloom is a fantastic reward as well as lowering blood pressure and improving physical and mental wellbeing. If you feel you could benefit from helping out, either pop in or leave your details on 01952 - 382340 and we will be in touch.

www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

Junior FOTTP

Due to a problem with finding enough volunteers and one or two other issues, the Junior Rangers section of the Friends has been put on hold for the time being. If anyone has any interest in assisting with the junior section please let us know by leaving your details at the Visitor Centre Telford Town Park or by contacting us via our web site. Thank you.

www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

News Round Up



Last year the prestigious Green Flag Award was awarded to Telford Town Park. We now have to ensure that the standards in the park remain high in order to keep it for many years to come.

The Friends of Telford Town Park will be sending a delegation, along with 2 park staff members, to the first Love Parks National Conference in Nottingham in March. Several nominations have been made for some more awards, so fingers crossed!



*The Friends are pleased to have had the sponsorship of the Southwater Event Group for the past 3 years and hope that this will continue for 2016 and beyond. Thank you **Southwater Event Group***

The International Centre, Holiday Inn, Ramada Hotel & International Hotel

News Round Up



CLEAN FOR THE QUEEN

FRIDAY 4TH MARCH FROM 10AM TILL 2PM

Meet at the Visitor Centre if you would like to take part in this NATIONAL clean up operation for Queen and Country !!! Even if you are not a royalist do come along and do it for our beautiful town park to make it even better. All over the UK from 4 March to the 6 March people will be clearing up the country. Unfortunately, although better than it has ever been, there are still many areas of Telford Town Park that could do with a big tidy up. Please come along and offer your help if only for an hour or so. Tools and bags will be provided but if you can bring your own gloves and black bags so much the better! If there are enough volunteering, we could arrange a Saturday clean up as well on the 5th or even Sunday the 6th.

2016 the year of the Gorilla !

Well not really but the gorillas are coming to Telford Town Park courtesy of **The British Iron Works** near Oswestry. See these beasts in the 'flesh' at Telford Town Park from Sat 2 April when 'Spring into the Park' will launch these sculptures in the Chelsea and Maxell Gardens. Please do not feed them!





They have bikes for hire, cycle repairs and sales along with cycle training for ALL ages. They are situated at the rear of the Visitor Centre and open from 10am - 4.30pm Tuesdays - Sundays inclusive. Winter hours may vary, so please check with the Visitor Centre on 01952 382340 or the number below:

0845 - 4348451



Aston, near Oswestry, SY11 4JH
Telephone: 0800 6888386

www.britishironworkcentre.co.uk

New showroom now open

Please support and visit the British Iron Work centre who are generously loaning us some gorillas for the park

Town Park
Adventure Golf
Course
Loads of fun for all
ages

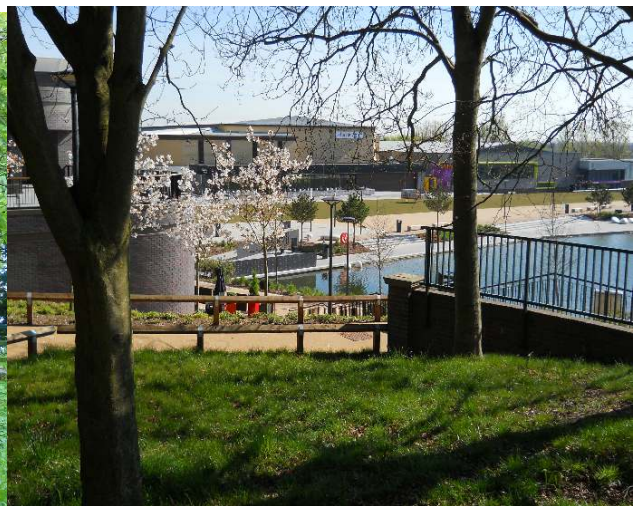
Tickets from the
Visitor Centre

01952 382340



Courtesy of the Shropshire Star

Telford Town Park



Clockwise from top left: Refurbished seating in Chelsea Gardens, bronze horse, Maxell gazebo, Southwater Lake, Family fun day and Giants Parade. For more information on events and walks in the park contact the Visitor Centre. 01952 - 382340

WHAT'S ON IN THE PARK

There's always lots going on in the Park for people of all ages. With the Easter Holidays coming up there's plenty for children and families and a lot of it is free of charge. **Please double check dates and times on the day before leaving home.**

Every Saturday	Park Run 08.30am - 10.30am.
Learn to Balance & Ride	Every Sat 11.0am £3 per session.
Mon 15 Feb - Fri 19 Feb	Stokes Fun Fair (tbc)
Friday 4 March	Clean for the Queen litter pick
13 March	Ironbridge Half Marathon
24 Mar - 11 Apr	Stokes Fun Fair (tbc)
Sat 2 April	Spring into the Park
Mon 11 - Thur 14 April	FIT show at Telford International Centre
Saturday 30 April	Autism Rainbow Run
Sat 1 May - Sat 8 May	Stokes Fun Fair (tbc)
Sun 22 May	Race for Life
Sat 28 May	Carnival
Mon 30 May - Fri 3 June	Stokes Fun Fair
Sun 12 th June	Severn Hospice Colour Run
Sat 25 June	Armed Forces Day Poppy Appeal
Sun 10 July	Telford Half Marathon



Keep up to date with the Friends of Telford Town Park

Visit our website www.friendsoftelfordtownpark.org

Find us on Facebook <https://www.facebook.com/FOTTP>

Follow us on Twitter <https://twitter.com/FOTTP>

Call into the Park Visitor Centre or telephone 01952 - 382340

